NOT MEASUREMENT SENSITIVE

MIL-B-14632C
25 June 1991
SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-14632B
31 December 1981

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BADGE, QUALIFICATION, ROTC AND NDCC, GENERAL SPECIFICATION FOR

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope - This specification covers qualification badges used in the ROTC and NDCC programs.

1.2 Classification - Badges covered by this specification shall be as specified herein and on the applicable specification sheets (see 3.1, 6.2 and supplement 1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

NN-P-71 - Pallet, Material Handling, Wood Stringer Construction, 2 Way and 4 Way
C-F-206 - Felt Sheet; Cloth, Felt, Wool, Pressed
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup

MILITARY

MIL-F-495 - Finish, Chemical, Black for Copper Alloys
MIL-P-15011 - Pallet, Material Handling, Wood Post Construction, 4 Way Entry
(See Supplement 1 for list of associated Specification sheets)

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-151 - Metal, Test Methods
FED-STD-406 - Plastics: Methods of Testing
FED-STD-595 - Colors

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in preparing this document should be address to: Director, The Institute of Heraldry, US Army, Cameron Station, Alexandria, VA 22304-5050, by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document.

AMSC N/A FSC 8455
DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T03:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards and handbooks are available from: Standardization Document Order Desk, Building 4D, Section D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.1.2. Other Government documents, drawings and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

DRAWINGS

THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY

B-13-12 - Attaching device Heraldic, prong and clutch type

STANDARD

THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY

Standard color chip set

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and specification sheets required by the contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

(Figure 1 is a miniature copy of an Institute of Heraldry drawing and is for information only.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extend specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS

ASTM-B-487 - Method for Measurement of Metal and Oxide Coating Thickness by Microscropical Examination of a Cross Section.

ASTM-B-2240 - Rubber Property-durometer Hardness.

ASTM-B-3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging.

(Application for copies of ASTM publications should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

THE COLOR ASSOCIATION OF THE UNITED STATES

United States Army Color Card, The Official Colors for Branches, Agencies, etc.

(Application for copies of the color cards should be addressed to the Color Association of the United States., 343 Lexington Avenue, New York, NY 10016.)

(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other information services)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T03:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein (except for related associated detail specifications, specification sheets, or MS standards), the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Specification sheets. The individual item requirements shall be as specified herein and in accordance with the applicable MS sheet. In the event of any conflict between the requirements of this specification and the MS sheet, the latter shall govern.

3.2 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection.

3.3 Standard sample. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.3), the contracting office shall furnish a standard sample or approved guide sample which shall be used for matching color and finish only. Variations from this specification may appear in the standard sample or approved guide sample; however, in such cases the specification shall govern.

3.4 Material. The material shall be as specified herein. Recovered material shall be used to the maximum extent possible.

3.4.1 Solder. Solder shall be a silver alloy solder having a melting point of not less than 1075 degrees F (580 c).

3.4.2 Copper-base alloys. Copper base alloys shall be free from pits, scale (including red oxide), dents, cracks, nicks, deep scratches, segregations and foreign matter that will not be removed in later processing. The chemical composition of the applicable copper-base alloys shall be as shown in table I, when tested as specified in 4.6.1.

TABLE I. Chemical Composition

Copper base alloys	Composition (percent)						
	Copper	Nickel 1/	Lead (Max)	Iron (Max)	Manganese	Zinc	Others
Red brass	84-86		.05	.05		Rem	.15 Max
Yellow brass	64-68.5		.15	.05		"	.15 Max
Nickel Silver	63-66.5	16.5-19.5	.10	.25	.50	"	
Gilding metal	94-96		.03	.05		"	.13 Max

1/ Cobalt counting as nickel.

3.4.3 Gold for plating. Gold for plating shall be 24 karat.

3.4.4 Silver for plating. Silver for plating shall be no less than 99.5% pure.

3.4.5 Enamel.

3.4.5.1 Hard enamel. Hard enamel shall be a hard glass type vitreous enamel fused with metallic oxides to produce the desired shade and opacity or translucence.

3.4.5.2 Baking enamel. Enamel shall be a flat synthetic baking enamel pigmented to match black shade 37038 established in FED-STD-595.

3.4.6 Epoxy resin (stoning epoxy). Epoxy resin shall be a stoning epoxy, have a shore D harness of 85 and incorporate an ultraviolet inhibitor.

3.4.7 Lacquer. Lacquer shall be a pale clear synthetic lacquer. The use of pigmented lacquers shall not be permitted.

3.4.8 Felt. The felt for the additional award for the academic wreath shall conform to type III, class 7A1 of C-F-206.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T03:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4.8.1 Colors. Color shall be in accordance with United States Army Standard Color Card and the cable numbers specified on the applicable specification sheet.

3.4.8.2 Matching. Color shall match the standard under natural (North Sky) daylight or artificial daylight having a color temperature of 7500 degrees Kelvin and shall be good approximation to the standard shade under incandescent lamp light at 2800 degrees Kelvin.

3.5 Design. The embossed design of the buttons and insignia shall be an exact duplicate of the Government loaned hubs (see 3.9) from which the contractor's working dies shall be extracted. The contractor's working dies shall be tooled and polished to remove any dents, nicks, scratches, or other imperfections. If the Government furnished hub is not pebbled, the contractor shall tool pebbling into the working die when required.

3.6 Construction. Badges shall be constructed in accordance with the applicable specification sheet and the requirements specified herein.

3.6.1 Stamping, trimming and piercing. Badges shall be struck in such a manner to insure a well defined die-struck outline. All edges shall be clean, free from burrs, drag, step and rough edges. The piercing and trimming operations shall not distort the design or alter the shape of the badge.

3.6.2 Soldering and electronic fusion. Joints shall be soldered or electronically fused. When solder is used, hard solder shall be as specified in 3.4.1. There shall be no excess solder and all excess flux shall be removed. Joints shall be clean, smooth, strong and free from burned or reduced areas. When tested as specified in 4.6.2.1, the soldered parts shall not separate. When electronic joints are used, the prong shall not separate at the joint when tested as specified in 4.6.2.2.

3.6.3 Attaching devices. Unless otherwise specified on the applicable specification sheet, the attaching device shall be prong and clutch type.

3.6.3.1 Prong and clutch type. Prongs shall be made from nickel silver specified in 3.4.2. Unless otherwise specified on the applicable specification sheet, the prongs as shown on drawing B-13-12 (figure 1) shall be 5/16 inch ± 1/64 inch (0.79 cm ± 0.04 cm) in length and shall be soldered or electronically fused in the locations specified in the applicable specification sheet. Clutches as shown on drawing B-13-12 (figure 1) shall be made from any type brass. When tested as specified in 4.6.3. it shall not be possible to remove the clutch from the prong without first depressing the release wings.

3.6.3.2 Registering prong. When a registering prong is required, the prong shall be 3/16 inch ± 1/64 inch (0.48 cm ± 0.04 cm) in length and .026 inch ± .002 inch (0.066 cm 0.005 cm) in diameter. Unless otherwise specified, the prong shall be made of nickel silver and shall be secured to the badge by soldering or electronic fusion.

3.7 Finish. Unless otherwise specified, the front and edges (surfaces visible from the front) shall be finished as specified on the applicable specification sheet and shall match the color and finish of the standard sample or the approved guide sample (see 3.3). Where plating or oxidizing is specified, the entire item (front, back and edges), except for the attaching devices, shall be plated or oxidized as applicable. The finish on the backs of gold plated items shall match the standard sample. Unless otherwise specified on the applicable specification sheet, the backs of all oxidized items shall be clean, i.e., uniformly oxidized.

3.7.1 Plating. All plating shall be by electroplating methods. Prior to plating, surfaces shall be cleaned of matter that may affect the plating. The plated surface shall be nonporous and continuous over the entire plated surface. There shall be no cut through, peeled, or blistered plating.

3.7.1.1 Gold Plating. Gold plating shall be accomplished using gold specified in 3.4.3. The use of white metals as an underplating for gold shall be permitted. When tested as specified in 4.6.4, there shall be no visible chemical reactions, such as evolution of gases.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T03:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.7.1.2 Silver plating. Silver plating shall be accomplished using silver specified in 3.4.4. Brass items shall be hot nickel underplated a minimum of 0.0003 inch thick and shall be smooth, fine grained, adherent and free from visible blisters, pits, porosity, indications of excessive build up or other defects. Nickel underplating and silver plating thickness testing shall be standard commercial. In case of a dispute, testing shall be in accordance with ASTM B487.

3.7.2. Lacquering. The attachment bar, silver plated badges and entire recondo badge shall be coated with lacquer specified in 3.4.7. Gold plated items may be lacquered at the option of the manufacturer. The dry lacquer film shall be continuous, level, adherent and free from lint, dust or other foreign matter. When tested as specified in 4.6.5.1, there shall be no change in the appearance of the clear lacquer surface except a slight overall yellowing of the highlights. When tested as specified in 4.6.5.2, the tissue shall not adhere to the lacquered surface.

3.7.3 Enameling. Enameling shall be applied so as to be uniform in color, free from bubbles, foreign inclusions, cracking, crazing or other defects which affect appearance. There shall be no overrunning of enamel.

3.7.3.1. Hard enameling. Hard enamel specified in 3.4.5.1 shall be charged, fired and stoned level with the dikes. The enamel shall then be lapped, felted or wheel polished to produced a glass like finish. No design elements shall be removed during the stoning process. There shall be no noticeable burn spots as a result of the firing.

3.7.3.2 Baking enamel. When baking enamel is specified, baking enamel specified in 3.4.5.2 shall be used. Prior to enameling, the entire insignia shall be given a black chemical finish conforming to MIL-F-495. When tested as specified in 4.6.6.1 and 4.6.6.2 the enamel shall not flake or chip and no color shall transfer to the cotton except for a slight trace of residue.

3.7.4 Epoxy resin (stoning epoxy). Epoxy resin (stoning epoxy) specified in 3.4.6 shall be applied so as to be uniform in color, free from bubbles, foreign inclusion or other defects which affect appearance. There shall be no overrun of epoxy. The epoxy shall be stoned level with the dikes and lapped, felted or wheel polished to produce a glass like finish. No design elements shall be removed during the stoning process. When tested as specified in 4.6.7 the epoxy shall have a shore hardness of no less than 85D.

3.8 Government loaned property. Hubs will be loaned by the Government and shall be used to make the contractor's working dies necessary for one contract or order (see 3.5).

3.9 Markings. The contractor shall stamp his trademark or other identifying mark and the letter "GI" (for Government procurement only) legibly and inconspicuously on the back of each badge.

3.10 Workmanship. Badges shall be clean, well made and shall meet the acceptable levels established by this specification.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements (examinations and tests) as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to ensure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T03:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items shall meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspections set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of ensuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling inspection, as part of manufacturing operations, is an acceptable practice to ascertain conformance to requirements, however, this does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to accept defective material.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).

b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.3 Inspection conditions. Unless otherwise specified, all inspections shall be performed in accordance with the test conditions specified in 4.5 and 4.6.

4.4 First article inspection. Inspection and testing of the first article shall be made on a completely finished item for all provisions of this specification applicable to end product examination and tests.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Inspection shall be in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated (see 6.4).

4.5.1 Inspection of components.

4.5.1.1 Testing of components. In addition to the quality assurance provisions of the subsidiary specifications and drawings, inspection shall be performed on components and materials listed in table II for the test characteristics shown therein. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the requirements shall be applicable to the lot average.

TABLE II. Component testing

Component and lot expressed in terms of	Characteristic	Rqm't para	Test method	Rqmt appl to lot avg	#Determ per sample unit	Results reported as	Sample Unit
Copper base alloys, as applicable (1 pound)	Chemical compositon	3.4.2 and Table I	Method 111 of Fed Std No. 151	X	2 for each element (composite	To nearest 0.1%	One 4x4 sheet or equivalent for each alloy

4.5.1.2 Certification of compliance. Components and materials listed below may be accepted on the basis of a contractor's certification of compliance for requirements specified in the applicable paragraphs of this specification.

Component	Characteristic	Rqm't para
Solder	Material identification	3.4.1
Gold for plating	Material identification	3.4.3
Silver for plating	Material identification	3.4.4
Hard enamel	Material identification	3.4.5.1
Baking enamel	Material identification	3.4.5.2
Epoxy resin	Material identification	3.4.6
Lacquer	Material identification	3.4.7
Prong and Clutch	Material identification	3.6.3.1

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T03:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.5.2 Inspection of the end item.

4.5.2.1 Visual inspection of badges. Examination shall be made at a distance of approximately 16 to 22 inches. The defects found during the examination shall be classified in accordance with 4.5.2.11 and 4.5.2.1.2. The lots shall be inspected in accordance with 4.5.2.3. The unit of product for the examination in 4.5.2.1.1 and 4.5.2.1.2 shall be one completely fabricated badge.

4.5.2.1.1 Examination of insignia for defects in finish, design, material, construction, workmanship and marking. Defects designated by an asterisk (*) shall be classified as major when seriously affecting serviceability or appearance and minor when affecting appearance or serviceability but not seriously.

Examine	Defect	Classification		
		Major	(*)	Minor
COLOR AND FINISH	Does not compare favorably with approved guide sample	x	-	-
	Surfaces not smooth	-	*	-
	Discoloration or stain clearly noticeable	-	*	-
	Abraded, scuffed, scratched or otherwise damaged	-	*	-
	Black chemical finish is not continuous over the entire badge	x	-	-
	Not chemically finished	x	-	-
	Not type of chemical finish specified	-	*	-
ENAMELING (Baked)	Not enameled or area of no film	x	-	-
	Area of thin film	-	-	x
	Enamel not flat	-	*	-
	Not adherent, i.e., blistered, flaking or peeling	-	*	-
	Foreign matter imbedded	-	*	-
	Discoloration clearly noticeable	-	*	-
	Coating not continuous and level, i.e., runs, drips or drops	-	*	-
(hard)	Enamel not stoned level with dikes or not felted and polished (when applicable)	x	-	-
	Not enameled when required	x	-	-
	Enameled areas cracked, chipped or crazed	x	-	-
	Enameled area contains lump, bubbles, blister	-	*	-
	Any fishscale copperheads, scale or specking	-	*	-
	Enameled area contains a hole, depression or low spot	-	*	-
	Foreign inclusions in enamel	-	*	-
PLATING	Not plated	x	-	-
	Not plating specified	x	-	-
	Plating not smooth, not continuous or adherent or otherwise impaired	x	-	-
LACQUERING	Not lacquered	x	-	-
	Lacquer forms noticeable runs or contains foreign matter	-	*	-
	Coating is not smooth, e.g., is flaking, blistering or peeling	-	*	-

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T03:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Examine	Defect	Classification		
		Major	(*)	Minor
DESIGN	Detail altered and does not conform to Government hub or drawing (when applicable)	x	-	-
	Any warp, twist or distortion producing irregular surface contour or outline	-	*	-
	Detail struck over, resulting in a double impression	x	-	-
	Any significant detail not clear, marred, missing, reduced or obliterated	-	*	-
MATERIAL	Not fabricated of the specified material	x	-	-
Construction and workmanship	Not trimmed to die struck edge	-	*	-
	Piercing not clean and smooth, e.g., any burrs, cutter, drill or file marks	-	*	-
	Dent, pit, dig, gouge, nick, pores, metal mark or mutilation	-	*	-
	Any solder spatter on front or visible edge exposed or concealed by finish	-	*	-
	Any component missing or misplaced	-	*	-
	Defective, e.g., any part damaged or malformed affecting use	-	*	-
	Sharp or rough edges or corners in forced areas	-	*	-
	Superimposed device is not tight fit to base and is not securely riveted to the base, i.e., rivet is loose, poorly or insufficiently peened or swaged	-	*	-
	Forcer used when not permitted	-	-	x
ATTACHING DEVICE	Defective, e.g., any part damaged or malformed affecting use	-	*	-
	Not positioned as specified	-	*	-
SOLDERING OR FUSION	Prong not completely joined by solder or not completely fused	-	*	-
	Any area burned or reduced in soldering	-	*	-
	Flux or excess solder not removed	-	-	x
	Any solder spatter exceeding 3/16 inch in maximum dimension	-	*	-
MARKING	Not marked as specified or missing	-	-	x

4.5.2.1.2 Examination of badges for defects in dimension. Any dimension which is not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect.

4.5.2.1.3 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels. The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) expressed in defects per hundred units shall be as follows:

	Inspection Level	AQL Major	AQL Total
For examinations applicable to 4.5.2.1.1	II	2.5	15.0
For examinations applicable to 4.5.2.1.2	S2	One class	4.0

4.5.3 Testing of the end item. Testing of the completely fabricated badge shall be performed for the characteristics shown herein. Except for testing of fused prongs, there shall be one determination per sample unit shall be reported as pass or fail. For end item testing of fused prongs, the sample unit shall be one item and all prongs on the item shall be tested; however, one defect will be scored regardless of

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T03:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

how many prongs on that item fail. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL shall be 6.5 defects per hundred units.

Characteristic	ROM'T	Test Method
Solder	3.6.2	4.6.2.1
Electronic fusion	3.6.2	4.6.2.2
Prong/Clutch	3.6.3.1	4.6.3
Gold plating	3.7.1.1	4.6.4
Silver plating	3.7.1.2	Std Comm
Lacquering	3.7.2	4.6.5.1 and 4.6.5.2
Baking enamel	3.7.3.2	4.6.6.1 and 6.6.2
Epoxy	3.7.4	4.6.7

4.5.4 Examination for count of badges in intermediate containers. Badges packaged for shipment shall be examined to determine conformance with package markings and specified quantity. The sample unit for this examination shall be one box (interior package). Any box containing less than the specified or marked quantity of badges shall be classified as a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 defect per hundred units. The lot size shall be the number of intermediate containers.

4.5.5 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing and marking requirements are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, or improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing. Any component damaged, affecting serviceability.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of component, such as, incomplete closure of case liner, container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate strapping, Bulging or distortion of containers.
Weight or content	Number of intermediate containers is more or less than required; gross/net weigh exceeds requirements.

4.6 Tests.

4.6.1 Chemical composition test. Chemical composition shall be determined in accordance with method III of FED-STD-151. Results shall be evaluated to determine compliance with the requirements in 3.4.2.

4.6.2. Soldering.

4.6.2.1 Test for hard soldered joints. Hard soldered badges shall be placed in an oven maintained at 1065 degrees F., plus or minus 5 degrees F., for 15 minutes. While at this temperature the insignia shall be lifted by the attaching device and shall be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.6.2.

4.6.2.2 Test for fused joints. Item to be tested shall be anchored on a horizontal surface. All prongs shall be grasped at least 1/3 its length above the fused joint and bent through an angle of 90 degrees (45 degrees to each side of vertical) until the prong breaks. The fused joint shall then be examined to determine compliance with 3.6.2. A bending tool in the form of a 45 degree template may be used for this test provided the prong is gripped at least 1/3 its length above the fused joint.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T03:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.6.3. Test for prong and clutch type. The clutches shall be removed and replaced 10 times from the prong using the clutch release wings. An attempt shall then be made to remove the clutch by hand without first pressing the release wings to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.6.3.1.

4.6.4. Acid test for gold plating. The test acid shall be applied as follows: Place a drop of acid of not less than 1/16 inch (0.16 cm) in diameter on three different spots on the obverse of the plated surface allowing the drops to remain for not less than one minute, during which time the surface of the insignia shall be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements of 3.7.1.1. The test acid shall be applied at room temperature and shall consist of a solution containing 50 percent by volume of CP nitric acid (specific gravity 1.42) and an equal volume of distilled water. If the test insignia has been lacquered. The lacquer shall be removed prior to testing.

4.6.5 Lacquer.

4.6.5.1 Liver of sulfur test. The samples to be tested shall be immersed in a 2 percent by weight of CP liver of sulphur (potassium sulfide) water solution, at a temperature of 100 F. to 110 F. for a period of three minutes. The Samples shall be removed and rinsed in warm, then cold, then hot water, after which it shall be wiped gently with an absorbent cellulose material or whirled to remove residual moisture, allowed to air dry at room temperature (60 to 80 degrees F) for a period of one hour and then examined to determine compliance with 3.7.2.

4.6.5.2 Tackiness test. At room temperature (60 to 80 degree F) press a piece of tissue paper against the lacquered surface for 15 seconds, using any pressure capable of being exerted between thumb and two fingers, after which the pressure shall be released and the item inspected to determine compliance with 3.7.2.

4.6.6. Baked enamel.

4.6.6.1 Knife test. Draw a knife edge across the face side of the specimen making four parallel scores 1/16 inch (0.16 cm) apart. Repeat this process drawing the knife perpendicular to the previously scored lines, making small blocks in the finish. The finish shall then be examined to determine compliance with 3.7.3.2.

4.6.6.2 Acetone test. The enameled surface shall be wiped five times with a piece of cotton saturated with acetone. The cotton shall be examined to determine compliance with 3.7.3.2.

4.6.7 Test for Shore hardness of Epoxy. Shore hardness shall be determined in accordance with ASTM 2240. Results shall be evaluated to determine compliance with the requirements of 3.7.4.

5. Packaging

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be levels A or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2.).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit packaging. Each badge shall be mounted on square white sulfite cards having a minimum thickness of 0.011 inch (0.27 cm). Each mounted badge shall then be packaged in a snug-fitting transparent polyethylene film bag. The polyethylene film shall be a minimum of 0.002 inch (0.005 cm) thick and all seams and closures shall be effected by heat sealing. Prior to or during the heat sealing operation, excess air within the bag shall be expelled. The size of the cards shall be as follows:

For stars: 1-3/4 inch square (4.45 cm).

For all other badges: 3 inches by 2 inches (7.62 cm by 5.08 cm)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T03:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate packaging. Two hundred (200) unit packages, except for stars, shall be packaged face to face and back to back in a snug-fitting paperboard box conforming to type I, variety 1, class A, style 4 of PPP-B-676. Two hundred (200) stars packaged as specified in 5.1.1.1 shall be bulk packaged in a snug-fitting paperboard box conforming to type I, variety 1, class A, style container 4 of PPP-B-676. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification. The use of Scotch Brand box closing filament tape no. 898 or equal, 1/2", using a minimum of two 1/2" x 4" ("L" Clips) on each edge may be utilized as an alternate method for effecting closure of set-up boxes.

5.1.2 Commercial. Badges shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with the applicable requirements of ASTM-D-3951.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level B or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.2 Level B. Two thousand (2000) badges packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a snug-fitting shipping container conforming to type CF or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.2 Commercial. Badges of one type and class only, packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in accordance with the applicable requirements of ASTM-D-3951.

5.3 Palletization. Unitized loads, commensurate with the level of packing specified in the contract or order, shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load type 1A of MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means C, K and L or O or P. Pallet pattern shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. The pallet shall be 4-way, Type I, Class 1, Style 1, Size A, Wood Group I, II, III, or IV, of MIL-P-15011, or 4-way, Type IV, V or VIII Class 1, Style A, size, 2, Wood Group I, II, III or IV, Grade A of NN-P-71. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the pallet pattern used shall be approved by the contracting officer.

5.4 Marking. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or purchase order, intermediate boxes, shipping containers and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. Notes

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. Badges covered by this specification are intended to be worn by ROTC and NDCC personnel to indicate the wearer has reached a specified level of proficiency in a given field.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.

(b) The number and date of the applicable specification sheet (see 1.2 and 2.1).

(c) When a standard sample will not be furnished (see 3.3).

(d) When a first article is not required (see 3.2).

(e) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 Samples. For access to guide samples, address the contracting activity issuing the invitation for bids.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T03:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.4 First article. When first article inspection is required, the contracting officer should provide specific guidance to offerors whether the item should be a preproduction sample, a first production sample or a standard production item from the contractor's current inventory as specified in 4.4. The first article should consist of one completely fabricated badge. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examinations, approval of first article test results and disposition of first articles. Invitations for bids should provide that the Government reserves the right to waive the requirement for samples for first article inspection to those bidders offering a product which has been previously acquired or tested by the Government, and that bidders offering such products, who wish to rely on such production or tests, must furnish evidence with the bid that prior Government approval is presently appropriate for the pending contract.

6.5 Government-loaned property. The contracting officer should arrange to loan the property listed in 3.8.

6.6 Subject term (key word) listing

Insignia

6.7 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - IH
Air Force - 11

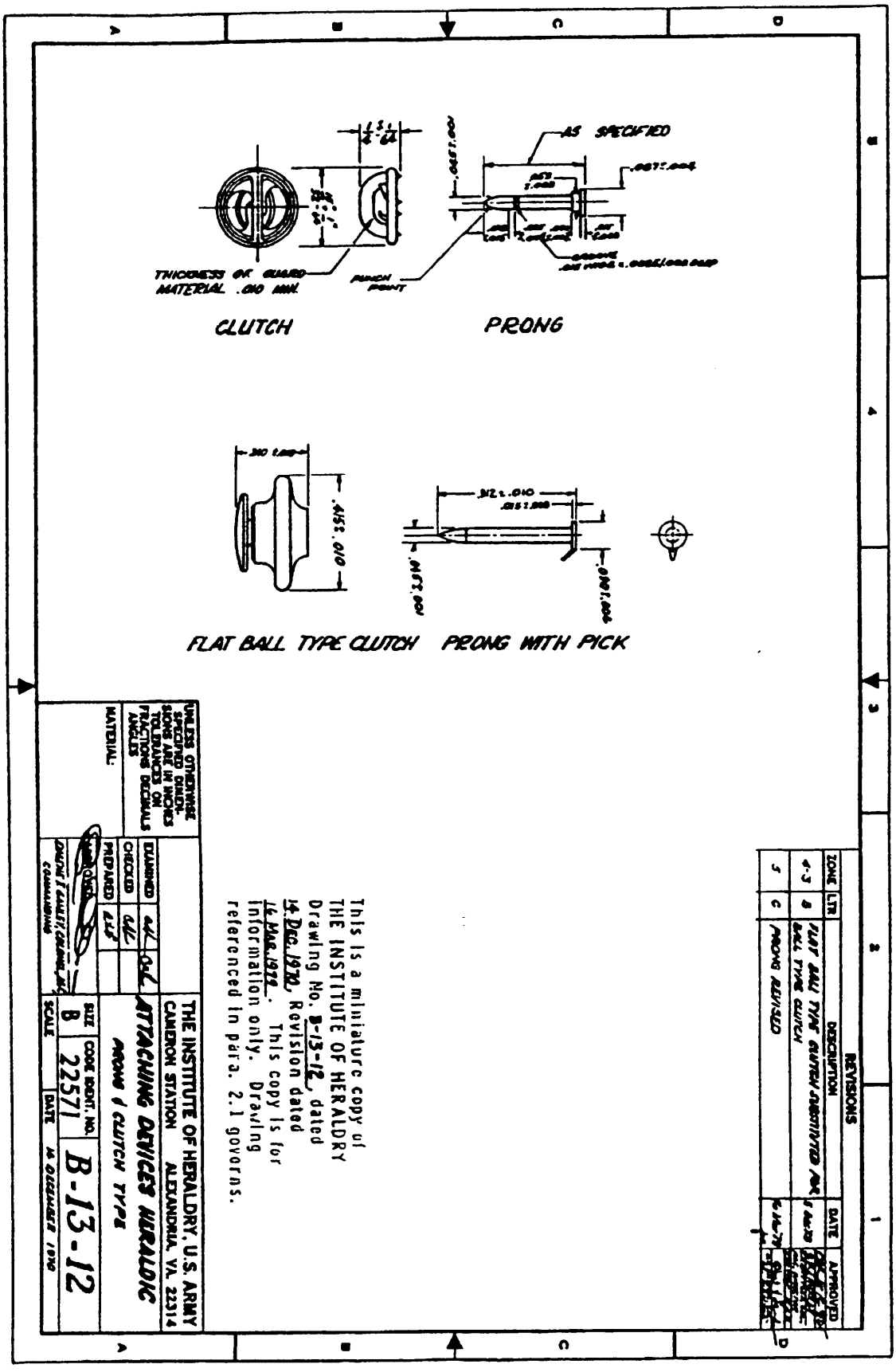
Review Activities:
Air Force - 99
DLA - CT

User Activity:
Air Force - 45

Preparing Activity:
Army - IH

(Project No. 8455-0571)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T03:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T03:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)
	MIL-B-14632C	910625

3. DOCUMENT TITLE
Badge, Qualification, ROTC and NDCC, General Specification For

4. NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)*

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial	(2) AUTOVON
The Institute of Heraldry	(703) 274-6636	284-6636
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) Bldg 15, Technical & Production Division Cameron Station Alexandria, VA 22304-5050	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-01-18T08:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the most recent version before use.

DD Form 1426, OCT 89